

centric, tech-enabled experiences that match evolving expectations.

India remains an attractive market for health insurers, given the vast uninsured population and the need for innovation.

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INDIA'S LIFE INSURANCE INDUSTRY is distribution led with bancassurance and agency emerging as the dominant channels. Unlike in some mature markets, it is difficult and expensive to build digital and or physical distribution channels in India. This creates both opportunities and challenges for new entrants. Rushabh Gandhi, MD & CEO of IndiaFirst Life Insurance, explains, "There are two main options: build your own distribution network—which takes time and deep pockets—or acquire an existing player with strong distribution in place."

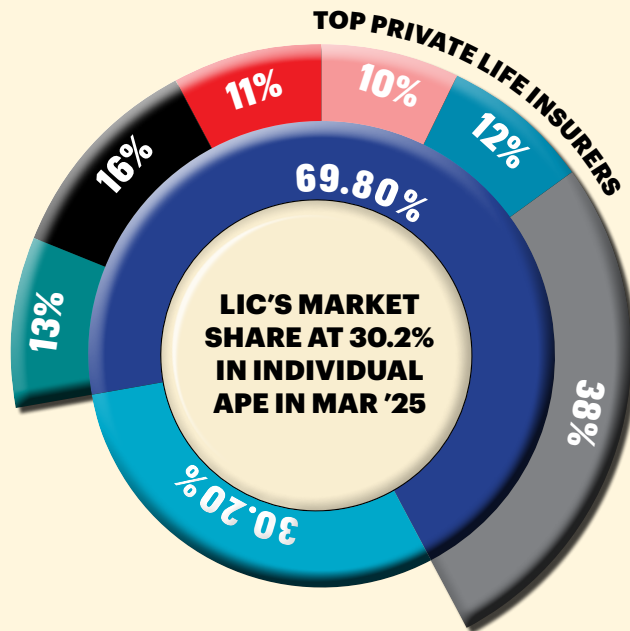
Though this landscape presents significant challenges for foreign players looking to enter India, the former can still help modernise distribution by bringing in digital tools and artificial intelligence (AI)-powered solutions to boost agent productivity. According to McKinsey, despite a threefold rise in active life agents in the past four years, India's annual premium equivalent (APE) per agent is still less than half of what it is in countries such as China and Indonesia.

Shruti Ladwa, Partner and Insurance Leader at EY India, notes, "Most foreign insurers see India as a high-growth market. The focus is now on profitability and operational efficiency. We will see both consolidation and fresh entrants."

But it is not certain that foreign players, despite the 100% FDI now and clear appreciation of the potential, will take the plunge. In fact, after the FDI limit

LIC VS THE REST

• LIC's share in individual annual premium equivalent



● PRIVATE PLAYERS ● LIC
● SBI LIFE ● HDFC LIFE ● TATA AIA
● ICICI PRUDENTIAL ● MAX LIFE ● OTHERS

NOTE APE, ANNUALISED PREMIUM EQUIVALENT, IS SUM OF THE ANNUALISED FIRST-YEAR PREMIUMS ON REGULAR PREMIUM POLICIES AND 10% OF SINGLE PREMIUMS WRITTEN

SOURCE JM FINANCIAL REPORT

GENERAL LEADERS

• The four PSU general insurers lead in premiums

● OTHERS
● PSU
● ICICI LOMBARD
● BAJAJ ALLIANZ GENERAL
● HDFC ERGO
● STAR HEALTH
● TATA

FIGURES ARE FOR Q4FY25
SOURCE EMKAY REPORTS

